TEXORA · LECTURE SHEET

Basic Principle of Fancy Yarn Production

A fancy yarn is engineered irregularity: an effect material is fed faster than the yarn is delivered, so the surplus length has nowhere to go except into loops, snarls, slubs or wraps. This sheet covers the three-component architecture, the overfeed principle that creates every effect, and the three main production routes.

YM-4103 · SPECIAL YARN MANUFACTURING · TOPIC 2 · LEVEL 4 TERM 1 · YARN MANUFACTURING SPECIALIZATION

1. What makes a yarn “fancy”?

An ordinary yarn is judged by how uniform it is. A **fancy yarn** (also called novelty or effect yarn) reverses that judgement: a variation of thickness, colour, material or surface form is introduced **deliberately, controllably and repeatably** along the yarn length, so that the finished fabric gains a decorative texture or pattern that weaving or knitting alone cannot produce. The irregularity is a design variable — its size, spacing and frequency are set on the machine, repeated to a pattern, and inspected like any other specification. A random thick place is a fault; the same thick place placed every 25 cm to a design is a slub effect.

Fancy yarns are used where surface interest sells the fabric: boucle and tweed jacketings, hand-knitting yarns, furnishing fabrics, dress fabrics with slub or knot effects, and contrast threads in denim and shirting. Because the effect is fragile compared with a plain yarn, fancy yarns are most often used as weft, as knitting yarn, or as a minority warp component protected by a plain ground warp.

2. The three components

Almost every fancy yarn is assembled from up to three components, each with a distinct job. Understanding which component does what is the key to both designing a fancy yarn and diagnosing its faults.

2.1 Effect yarn (effect material)

The component that creates the visible effect — the loops of a boucle, the soft cloud of a chenille, the thick place of a slub yarn. It may be a spun yarn, a filament yarn, a roving, or even a pre-made fancy yarn used as feedstock. It is usually the softest, bulkiest or most coloured component, and crucially it is

overfed: supplied faster than the delivery speed so that surplus length piles into the effect (Section 3). Effect material is often the weakest component mechanically, which is why it cannot be left unbound.

2.2 Core or base yarn (ground yarn)

The load-bearing spine of the fancy yarn. The core is delivered at the machine's delivery speed, runs straight (or nearly straight) through the twisting zone, and gives the composite yarn its tensile strength and its nominal length. It is typically a firm, even, relatively fine yarn — frequently a filament or a ply yarn — chosen for strength rather than appearance, because in many profiles it is largely hidden inside the effect.

2.3 Binder yarn (tie yarn)

A fine, strong yarn wrapped or twisted around the assembly to lock the effect component onto the core. Without a binder, loops slip, flatten or shed in fabric processing; the binder is what converts a loose decorative wrapping into a durable yarn. The binder is normally finer than both other components so that it binds without dominating appearance, and it is twisted in the opposite sense where needed to lock rather than unwrap the structure. Not every fancy yarn needs a separate binder — in simple two-component yarns (e.g. a spiral yarn of two contrasting yarns) the components bind each other — but three-component construction is the general model.

COMPONENT	ROLE	FEED BEHAVIOUR	TYPICAL CHOICE
Effect yarn	Creates loops, slubs, colour or texture	Overfed — faster than delivery	Soft, bulky, coloured spun or filament yarn, roving
Core / base yarn	Strength, spine, defines delivered length	Fed at delivery speed	Firm fine yarn or filament, often ply
Binder yarn	Locks effect to core; durability	Fed at or near delivery speed, wraps the assembly	Fine strong filament or spun yarn

3. The overfeed principle

All fancy effects of the loop/snarl/wrap family are produced by one mechanism: feeding one component faster than the yarn leaves the machine. Define the **overfeed ratio** as:

$$\text{Overfeed ratio} = \text{effect-yarn feed length} / \text{delivered yarn length} \quad \cdot \quad \text{Overfeed \%} = (\text{feed} - \text{delivery}) / \text{delivery} \times 100$$

Consider 100 m of finished yarn delivered while 120 m of effect yarn is fed into the same twisting zone. The extra 20 m of effect yarn cannot disappear: conservation of length forces it out of the straight path. Depending on effect-yarn stiffness, twist and tension, the surplus escapes as:

- **Loops** — a soft, low-twist effect yarn buckles into rounded loops standing off the core (boucle / loop yarn).
- **Snarls** — a lively, high-twist effect yarn curls back on itself into tight kinks (snarl / fringe yarn).
- **Wraps** — a controlled surplus is laid as close helical wraps over a section of core (gimp, knop build-up).
- **Waves** — a small surplus gives a gentle undulation rather than discrete loops.

WORKED EXAMPLE — OVERFEED PERCENTAGE AND EFFECT FREQUENCY

Effect yarn is fed at 120 m for every 100 m of yarn delivered.
Overfeed % = (120 − 100) / 100 × 100 = **20% overfeed**; the overfeed ratio is 120 / 100 = **1.20**.
Effect on the yarn: every metre of finished yarn carries 1.20 m of effect yarn — 0.20 m of surplus per metre must appear as loops, snarls or wraps.
Frequency link: if the surplus is organised as loops each consuming about 2 cm of extra effect yarn, one metre of yarn can form roughly 0.20 / 0.02 = **10 loops per metre**. Doubling the overfeed to 40% at the same loop size doubles the loop frequency to about 20 per metre — overfeed, not delivery speed, is the designer's frequency control. (Loop consumption is an estimate for design illustration; the overfeed percentage itself is exact.)

Three further controls shape the effect. **Twist in the twisting zone** decides how firmly the surplus is trapped. **Effect-yarn character** — its stiffness, twist liveliness and bulk — decides which escape form the surplus takes at a given overfeed. **Patterning** — varying feed speed, stopping the effect feed, or exchanging effect yarns to a programme — turns a uniform effect into stripes, intermittent slubs and multi-effect designs. Modern fancy-yarn machines are therefore essentially programmable differential-feed twisting machines.

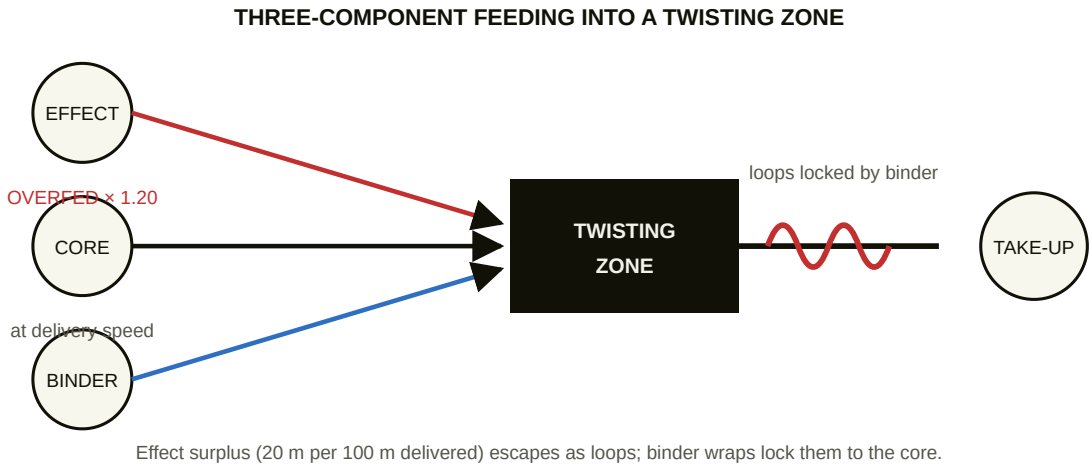


Figure 1 — Three-component feeding. The effect yarn is overfed into the twisting zone; core and binder run at delivery speed and trap the surplus length as a bound effect.

4. Production routes

4.1 Ring-frame based production

A conventional or modified ring spinning / ring twisting frame can produce simple fancy yarns. Two or more yarns or rovings are fed through separate, independently driven feed rollers into the drafting or twisting zone; differential roller speeds create the overfeed, and the ring spindle twists and winds the assembly in one operation. Slub yarns are made this way by programmed variation of drafting-roller speed, and simple spiral and two-tone yarns by feeding two rovings or yarns together. Advantages: uses installed spinning machinery, good twist insertion, moderate cost. Limits: spindle speed and traveller limits cap production; complex multi-stage effects need a second twisting pass, often with binder applied on a separate doubler-winder or twisting frame — the classic loop yarn, for example, is made in a first twisting (effect overfed onto core) followed by a second, opposite twisting that applies the binder.

4.2 Hollow-spindle wrapping

The binder (or the effect wrapping yarn) is carried on a package mounted on a hollow, rotating spindle. The core and effect components pass straight through the hollow spindle axis while the rotating package wraps its yarn around them once per spindle revolution — wrapping without twisting the core assembly itself. Because the core is not twisted, tensions are low, speeds are high, and multiple hollow spindles in series can apply successive wraps (effect wrap, then binder wrap in the opposite direction) in a single pass. This is the dominant modern route for fancy yarns and also the machine behind wrap yarns and many core-spun products (Topics 4 and 5). Wraps per metre are set by spindle speed divided by delivery speed, so wrap density is directly programmable.

4.3 Chenille machine (outline)

Chenille is built differently: pile yarns are wrapped around a pair of spaced gauge blades (calipers) while two core yarns lock them; a rotary knife then cuts the pile wraps between the blades, producing two chenille yarns whose cut pile stands radially from the core like a caterpillar. The principle is covered fully in Topic 3; it is listed here because it is the third distinct machine architecture — formation by cutting a wrapped pile rather than by overfeed alone.

ROUTE	LOCKING MECHANISM	STRENGTHS	LIMITS / TYPICAL USE
Ring-frame based	True twist from ring spindle	Installed base, strong twist, low capital	Slower; complex effects need 2 passes; slub, spiral, simple loop
Hollow-spindle	Helical wrapping, core untwisted	Fast, low tension, multi-wrap in one pass	Wrap can slip if under-bound; fancy, wrap and core yarns

Chenille machine	Core yarns lock cut pile	Unique velvet pile effect, high output of its type	Dedicated machine; chenille only

5. Process control and common faults

- **Effect too open / loops shed** — binder wraps too few or too slack; increase binder feed tension or wraps per metre, or add a second binding pass.
- **Effect disappears in places** — effect feed slipping or overfeed dropping; check feed-roller pressure and drive programming.
- **Core grinning through** — effect coverage too low; raise overfeed or use a bulkier effect yarn.
- **Uneven repeat** — pattern programme and delivery speed out of synchronisation; effect spacing is programmed in delivered length, so delivery variation stretches the design.

The unifying diagnostic rule: identify which component is at fault before adjusting the machine. Strength faults belong to the core, durability faults to the binder, appearance faults to the effect feed — adjusting the wrong component converts one fault into another.

Glossary

Fancy yarn — yarn with deliberate, repeatable decorative irregularity. **Effect yarn** — component creating the visible effect. **Core (base) yarn** — load-bearing spine fed at delivery speed. **Binder yarn** — fine strong yarn locking the effect to the core. **Overfeed ratio** — effect feed length divided by delivered length. **Overfeed %** — excess feed as a percentage of delivery. **Hollow spindle** — rotating spindle with axial passage that wraps a yarn around through-running components. **Grinning** — core showing through insufficient effect coverage.

Key points

• A fancy yarn = effect + core + (usually) binder; each component has one job — appearance, strength, durability.
• Every loop/snarl/wrap effect is stored surplus length: overfeed % = (feed − delivery) / delivery × 100.
• At fixed loop size, effect frequency rises in proportion to overfeed — overfeed is the frequency control.
• Ring frames make simple effects with true twist; hollow spindles wrap at high speed without twisting the core; chenille is formed by cutting a wrapped pile.
• Diagnose by component: appearance → effect feed, strength → core, durability → binder.

Practice

1. An effect yarn is fed at 135 m per 100 m delivered. Calculate the overfeed ratio and overfeed %. If each loop consumes about 3 cm of surplus, estimate the loops per metre.
2. A fancy yarn sheds its loops in weaving although its appearance on the package is good. Identify the component at fault and state two machine adjustments that would correct it.
3. Compare ring-frame and hollow-spindle production for a loop yarn under the headings: locking mechanism, number of passes, and risk to a delicate effect yarn.
4. Explain why raising delivery speed alone (all feed speeds raised in the same proportion) does not change the effect frequency per metre, while raising effect feed speed alone does.

Answer key

1. Ratio = 135 / 100 = **1.35**. Overfeed % = (135 − 100) / 100 × 100 = **35%**. Surplus per metre = 0.35 m; loops ≈ 0.35 / 0.03 ≈ **12 loops per metre** (about 11–12).
2. The **binder** component — appearance is set by the effect feed, but retention is the binder's job. Increase binder wraps per metre (raise spindle speed relative to delivery or add a second binding pass) and/or increase binder tension / use a stronger, finer binder so wraps bite without showing.
3. Ring: locking by true twist of the whole assembly; loop yarn typically needs two passes (effect twisting, then opposite binder twisting); twist and traveller action are harsher on a delicate effect. Hollow spindle: locking by helical wraps, core untwisted; effect and binder wraps can be applied by successive spindles in one pass; low core tension is gentler on delicate effects and faster, but wraps must be dense enough not to slip.
4. Effect frequency per metre depends on surplus length *per delivered metre*, i.e. on the overfeed ratio. Raising all speeds proportionally keeps the ratio — and therefore loops per metre — unchanged (only output rate rises). Raising effect feed alone raises the ratio, storing more surplus in each metre, so more (or larger) effects form per metre.

Texora — course notes prepared from the official syllabus of B.Sc. in Textile Engineering · Made by Sakib